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O.K.'s Police State

NEW FEDERAL CRIME CODE PUTS A GUN TO YOUR HEAD



(Washington, D.C.) — Despite a successful nationwide effort led by Black and other progressive organizations that forced it to die on the Senate floor last year, the notorious Senate Bill No. 1 (S.1) — the repressive proposal for revision of the Federal Criminal Code, a legacy of the Nixon administration presented to Congress in 1975 — is back again, this time as S. 1437.

While there have been some modifications of the harshest features that existed in S.1, S. 1437 "retains a large number of provisions which, individually and in totality, are gravely detrimental to the American system of individual rights," according to Yale University Professor of Law Emeritus Thomas I. Emerson.

Now before the Senate Judiciary Committee, S. 1437 is the result of a compromise between Massachusetts Senator Edward Kennedy and Arkansas Senator John McClellan. Testifying before the Committee on June 21 of this year, Professor Emerson noted:

"Reform of the Federal Criminal Code is a worthwhile project. That reform is not, however, inconsistent with maintaining our system of individual rights. . . . S.1 was designed to impose a Watergate-type strait-jacket upon the people of this country. S. 1437 retains too many of those provisions to be acceptable...."

The Los Angeles-based National Committee
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S.1437 will legalize the rising police terror that is prevalent throughout the U.S. The bill, which is the defeated S.1 in disguise, is "gravely detrimental to the American system of individual rights," says the law professor emeritus Thomas Emerson.

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